



*Let the mind manage the body
Que l'esprit gère le corps*

**MAURITIUS
EXAMINATIONS
SYNDICATE**

**PSAC 2025
Arabic (P210)**

EXAMINERS' REPORT

April 2026

Introduction:

The Primary School Achievement Certificate (PSAC) Assessment for Arabic focuses on different linguistic competencies:

1. Reading Comprehension (40%)
2. Writing (30%)
3. Grammar and Vocabulary (30%)

General Comments:

The overall performance of candidates remained relatively consistent with previous cycles, achieving a satisfactory pass rate of 71.35%. This represents a marginal decrease from the 2024 pass rate of 71.57%. Analysis of the results indicates a clear disparity between fundamental literacy and higher-order cognitive skills. Candidates demonstrated high levels of proficiency in components assessing fundamental skills. Strong performance was noted in vocabulary exercises, multiple-choice questions, and functional reading tasks that required literal comprehension. Significant challenges persist in areas requiring inferential comprehension and more extended writing. A recurring concern is the composition component, which remains the most difficult section for many candidates. The quality of essay writing continues to be a primary area for improvement. A significant number of the candidate pool failed to attempt the essay entirely, negatively impacting their overall marks. Among candidates who did provide a response, there were frequent instances of grammatical and spelling errors.

Comments on specific questions:

Question 1A (5 Marks) [5 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses candidates' knowledge of common vocabulary. The task requires candidates to label pictures correctly.

Comments:

- ❖ Most candidates attempted this question successfully, though a very small minority left the exercise entirely unanswered.
- ❖ A number of candidates struggled to distinguish between similar-sounding phonemes, such as ح/ه and ت/ة, resulting in spelling mistakes.
- ❖ A few candidates omitted the dots above and below words such as ق in قلم, and ي in سفينة, and hence, they were penalized for spelling mistake.
- ❖ Many candidates used several words such as سفينة / مركب / قارب to describe the picture of the ship, and marks were given as long as the meaning was sound.
- ❖ Some candidates did not write the ء on the ا while writing the word فأر.
- ❖ For the picture of the door, alternative answers such as دولا ب and نافذة were accepted .

The following is a list of the correct and wrong answers found:

Item	Correct Answers	Wrong Answers
1	قلم / قلم رصاص	كتب
2	سفينة / قارب / مركب	بحر
3	مظلة / مطرية	مطر
4	فأر / فار / حيوان	قط
5	باب / نافذة / دولا ب / مدخل	بيت

Recommendations:

- Given the phonetic similarities between certain Arabic letters, educators should prioritize exercises that focus on proper articulation and the distinct written forms of characters based on their position within a word (initial, medial, and final).
- Instruction should emphasize high-frequency vocabulary and lexical items used in daily life to bridge the gap between literal understanding and functional use.
- It is strongly advised that educators move away from an excessive reliance on the **translation method** (Mother-Tongue to Arabic) since candidates develop a perpetual recourse to translation, which limits their linguistic independence and confidence.
- Educators are encouraged to adopt more immersive, direct-method approaches that foster thinking and speaking directly in Arabic to better prepare candidates for higher-order tasks.

Question 1B (5 Marks) [5 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses reading comprehension ability at a basic level. This is done through a task which requires candidates to match a sentence to its corresponding picture.

Comments:

- ❖ The vast majority of candidates approached this question effectively, with a substantial proportion achieving the maximum available marks.
- ❖ A few candidates mistakenly linked two sentences to one picture which eventually resulted in loss of marks.
- ❖ A small number of candidates failed to draw their matching lines clearly or completely, resulting in ambiguous responses that were difficult to assess.
- ❖ This component proved to be one of the highest-scoring questions for candidates; nevertheless, better outcomes could be achieved through stricter adherence to the specified format and closer attention to task completion.

Recommendations:

- It is recommended that educators provide additional practice opportunities of this item to learners, with a specific focus on supporting **slow learners** to build their confidence and accuracy.
- Educators should consistently remind candidates of the importance of following specific task instructions—specifically, ensuring that sentences are correctly matched to their corresponding visual prompts.
- Candidates should be encouraged to use **rulers** when completing matching exercises to ensure that lines are clear, straight, and unambiguous for assessment.
- Educators are advised to train candidates to perform a **final count** of their completed matches before proceeding to the next section. This simple check ensures that no items are left unattended and that the response is complete.
- By focusing on technical precision and systematic verification, candidates can avoid losing marks on tasks they otherwise understand conceptually.

Question 2A (10 Marks) [10 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question tests knowledge and recognition of proper grammatical structures through multiple-choice items.

Comments:

- ❖ While candidate engagement with this question was high, achieving a perfect score proved difficult for the majority of candidates.
- ❖ Some candidates failed to follow the specific requirement to **encircle** the correct answer.
- ❖ A few candidates opted to tick, underline, cross out, or copy the response, while others invalidated their answers by selecting more than one option.
- ❖ While the attempt rate was high, isolated instances were noted where candidates left the items entirely blank.
- ❖ Candidates showed the greatest proficiency in **Items 1, 2, 3, and 8**.
- ❖ **Items 5, 6, and 9** were identified as the most difficult for the candidates.

The exercise evaluated the candidates' mastery of the following linguistic structures:

Item	Grammatical Focus
1	Proper application of relative noun
2	Correct use of Prepositions
3	Mastery of Personal Pronouns
4	Accurate application of Verb Tenses
5	Proper use of Interrogative Particles
6	Agreement between number and counted noun
7	Concord between adjective and noun
8	Correct Conjugation of the Imperfect Tense
9	Appropriate selection of Conjunctions
10	Agreement between Nominal Subject and Predicate

Recommendations:

- Educators are advised to ensure that the specific linguistic and technical weaknesses identified in this report are given dedicated attention in the classroom.
- Candidates should be encouraged to actively apply their grammatical knowledge when constructing sentences and drafting compositions, bridging the gap between theory and writing.
- Educators are advised to emphasize the **functional aspect of grammar**. Focusing on how rules operate in context will help candidates tackle applied grammar exercises more efficiently.
- Educators are further advised to design and implement a wide variety of grammatical exercises. Providing exposure to multiple rules ensures candidates gain sufficient practice and confidence before the examination.
- Educators are requested to consistently remind candidates to adhere strictly to task instructions (e.g., **encircling** the correct answer) and to emphasize the importance of attempting every item to avoid leaving multiple-choice questions blank.
- Candidates should be trained to identify and utilize the **grammatical clues** provided within a sentence (such as gender markers or tense indicators) before finalizing their choice of answer.

Question 2B (5 Marks) [5 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses candidates' ability to deal with vocabulary in context, through multiple-choice items.

Comments:

- ❖ The majority of candidates engaged with this question efficiently.
- ❖ A significant number of candidates managed to score full marks in this component.
- ❖ Some candidates failed to identify and utilize key context clues, resulting in arbitrary or random answer selections.

Recommendations:

- To enhance candidate performance in vocabulary-based tasks, educators are encouraged to adopt a more holistic and contextualized approach to teaching.
- Educators are advised to focus on basic functional vocabulary common to daily life, ensuring coverage across a variety of situational domains.
- Increased support should be provided for using vocabulary within context, particularly when constructing **compound and complex sentences**.
- Educators are recommended to train students to identify "answer indicators"—contextual clues found within the same sentence or in the following sentence—to determine the correct response.
- Students should be encouraged to integrate newly learned vocabulary into sentence-writing exercises. Mastery of appropriate word choice is a critical factor in improving overall examination performance.

Question 3 (10 marks) [10 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses reading comprehension at an intermediate level, in particular the ability to locate information from a text. Different types of informative texts may be used to elicit comprehension (e.g a short text, a poster, an advertisement, a letter, a postcard, invitation cards, etc...)

Comments:

- ❖ While the majority of candidates attempted this section, many failed to secure full marks due to a lack of precision and a tendency toward "indiscriminate lifting"—the inclusion of excessive, irrelevant information from the text.
- ❖ A significant number of candidates demonstrated a limited understanding of specific interrogative particles, leading to responses that did not align with what was being asked.
- ❖ Although performance was generally stable, scores were negatively impacted by candidates providing more information than required.

Specific trends include:

- **Item 2:** Only the **date** was required, candidates frequently included the day as well.
- **Item 4:** Candidates often provided both the opening and closing times, despite the question specifically asking only for the **opening time**.
- **Item 5:** Despite the question's specific focus on the **closing time**, a significant number of responses included the start time as well.
- **Item 7:** Where only **one** gift was requested, many candidates listed all three gifts.
- **Item 8:** The omission of the keyword تذاكر was a frequent error, preventing several candidates from securing the mark for this item.

Recommendations:

- Candidates are strongly advised to practice reading comprehension passages independently.
- Educators should gradually reduce in-class explanations so that students develop the confidence to navigate "unseen" texts on the day of the assessment.

- To foster essential reading skills, educators are encouraged to move away from word-for-word translation. Candidates should focus on grasping the **overall message** and context of a passage rather than attempting to decode every single word in isolation.
- Educators are requested to provide intensive practice on locating specific data points such as **date, time, place, names, causes, and actions**.
- It is important for educators to reinforce that **brief and accurate answers** are the most effective. Candidates should be taught that "more is not always better"; providing exactly what is asked is the key to securing full marks.
- Candidates must be warned that "lifting" entire chunks of text is rarely rewarded. Instead, they should practice extracting only the specific phrase or keyword required by the question to ensure their response remains unambiguous.
- Encourage candidates to use the surrounding grammatical and situational clues within the text to verify their answers before finalizing them.

Question 4A and 4B (15 marks) [15 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses candidates' ability in reading comprehension through their understanding of an extended passage (narrative, informative or descriptive). A range of reading comprehension skills is assessed in this question – locating explicit information, guessing the meaning of unfamiliar words from the context, recognizing relationships between persons, actions and events, following the sequence of events, inference, identifying central themes and ideas and providing a personal response to the text. This is done through multiple choice (4A – 5 marks) and open ended questions (4B – 10 marks).

Comments:

Question 4A (5 marks) [5 Items]

- ❖ While the majority of candidates attempted this section, the overall performance was average.
- ❖ Marks were lost due to technical errors; several candidates failed to encircle their answers as instructed, opting instead to tick, underline, or cross out their choices.
- ❖ Item-Specific Observations:
 - Items 1, 2 & 4: Most candidates answered these items correctly.
 - Item 3: Many candidates failed to identify the correct response.
 - Item 5: Some candidates showed confusion regarding the choice of correct answer.

Question 4B (10 marks) [10 Items]

- ❖ The results were similar to previous years. Most students could answer basic questions where the information was clearly stated in the text.
- ❖ Questions that required "reading between the lines" or making guesses based on information given in the text (inference) were difficult for most. Only the best candidates managed to answer these correctly.
- ❖ Some students did not seem to understand what the question words (who, where, when, etc.) were asking for.

- ❖ Many students copied long, unnecessary chunks of text from the passage rather than picking out the specific answer, which led to a loss of marks.
- ❖ Item number 5 proved to be the most problematic for candidates. It seems that they failed to understand the question.

Recommendations:

To help students improve their results in reading comprehension, educators are recommended to focus on both practical exam techniques and creative classroom activities.

Educators are encouraged to:

- Train students to tackle comprehension passages on their own. They need to learn how to interpret meaning and context without constant help from the teacher.
- Advise candidates to read Arabic stories regularly to build their vocabulary and comfort with the language.
- Teach students to pay close attention to the specific words used in a question. They should give **short, accurate answers** and avoid "lifting" (copying) large, unnecessary chunks of text.
- Give students more practice with questions that require common sense and logical thinking rather than just finding a word in the text.
- Practice exercises where students have to rearrange jumbled paragraphs. This helps them understand how to organize ideas coherently and logically.
- Spend more time on exercises that describe **feelings, emotions, and character traits**. This helps students move beyond literal meaning.
- Help students develop the skill of making "inferences"—using hints in the text to figure out something that isn't explicitly stated.
- While reading aloud in class, stop to ask "inferential" questions (e.g., *"Why do you think the character did that?"*) to keep them thinking deeply.
- Use pictures from magazines or newspapers to discuss emotions. Ask students to observe a person's face and provide evidence for their opinion (e.g., *"I think he is worried because his forehead is wrinkled"*).
- Use short passages with some words removed. Have students use the surrounding clues to figure out the best word to fill in the blank. This builds both vocabulary and higher-order thinking.

By shifting the focus from "translating" to "analyzing," students will become much more confident when they encounter an unfamiliar text on the day of the exam.

Question 5A (4 marks) [2 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses writing at the sentence level. Knowledge of syntax is assessed through re-arranging jumbled words.

Comments:

- ❖ The majority of candidates approached this question with confidence, successfully securing full marks.
- ❖ A few candidates struggled to place the words in the correct grammatical sequence.
- ❖ This question revealed a lack of awareness regarding "grammatical proximity" - the need to keep related words together- for example **أمام المركز** in item 1 and **لا يزور** in item 2.
- ❖ Several options were accepted in item 2 as long as the sentences are meaningful and grammatically and syntactically correct.
- ❖ While candidates generally possess the vocabulary, further practice is needed in maintaining the "unity" of grammatical pairs, such as adverbs with their nouns and verbs with their subjects.

Recommendations:

To help students maintain their confidence while improving their syntactic precision, educators are encouraged to implement the following strategies for sentence writing tasks:

- Teach students that certain words in Arabic are "best friends" and should rarely be separated. Use visual "brackets" or color-coding to show these functional units.
- Instead of treating every word in a jumbled list as an isolated unit, ask students to first find the pairs that belong together. Once they have these "blocks," they can then arrange the larger pieces to form a sentence.
- Provide exercises where the subject and verb are separated by other words in a list. Train students to identify the "doer" and the "action" first to establish the core of the sentence.
- Practice placing adverbs of place and time at the beginning or end of sentences so students understand where these units fit without breaking up the main subject-verb-object relationship.
- Give individual words to different students and have them physically stand in line to "build" a sentence. If a student with a negative particle (*La*) is standing away from the student with the verb (*Yazur*), the rest of the class must identify the error in "proximity."

- Start with jumbled 3-word sentences and gradually increase the complexity to 4 or 5 words. This prevents students from feeling overwhelmed and helps them apply their vocabulary knowledge to sentence structure more effectively.

The goal is to move students from simply "knowing the words" to "understanding the relationship" between them. By emphasizing which words must stay together, you can eliminate the most common errors seen in this year's assessment.

Question 5B (6 marks) [3 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question also assesses writing at the sentence level. Knowledge of syntax is assessed by a sentence completion task (6 marks).

Comments:

- ❖ Although most candidates attempted the question, their final scores were frequently lowered by persistent **grammatical, syntactical, and orthographical (spelling)** mistakes.
- ❖ A number of candidates either left parts of the task blank or skipped the question entirely.
- ❖ Many answers showed a clear influence of the candidates' **mother tongue**. This linguistic interference often led to literal translations that hindered natural Arabic phrasing and sentence structure.
- ❖ A significant number of candidates struggled to apply the correct verb forms and maintain proper sentence flow.
- ❖ The most frequent error identified across the board was the **misuse of verb tenses**, indicating a need for better mastery of time-reference in writing.

Item	Correct Sentences	Sentences having grammatical / orthographical mistakes	Sentences having syntactical mistakes (Incorrect order of words / Important word missing)
1	- فرح أحمد لأنه نجح في الامتحان	- فرح أحمد لأن هو نجح في الامتحان	- فرح أحمد لأن هدية
2	- بينما كانت والدتي تطبخ، أكلت الخبز والجبن	- بينما كانت والدتي تطبخ، أكل الخبز والجبن	- بينما كانت والدتي تطبخ، أساعد في المطبخ
3	- عندما أذهب إلى الشاطئ، أصبح في الماء الدافئ	- عندما أذهب إلى الشاطئ، أنا أكلت الخبز	- عندما أذهب إلى الشاطئ، نلعب الكرة القدم

Recommendations

To address the challenges in sentence completion and syntax for students, here are recommendations for educators:

- To stop the misuse of verb tenses, teach students to identify the "anchor verb" in the first clause. If the sentence starts in the past (e.g., *بينما كان*), the completion must stay in the past. Use visual timelines to show that both actions must happen on the same "side" of the clock.
- Explicitly teach students where literal translation from English or Creole fails in Arabic. Focus specifically on **Attached Pronouns**—drilling the fact that "Because he" is one word (*لأنه*) rather than two separate words (*لأن هو*).
- Use "word blocks" to show that certain units must stay together. For example, a subject and its verb (*فرح أحمد*) or an adverb and its noun (*عندما أذهب*) are "best friends" and should never be separated by other words in a sentence.
- To prevent students from lifting or copying words, challenge them to complete thoughts using **exactly three or four words**. This forces them to focus on the core logical answer and reduces the chance of making spelling (orthographical) errors in "filler" words.
- Create substitution tables where students must finish the same sentence for different subjects. This ensures that the verb in their completion always "mirrors" the person introduced at the start of the sentence.

Question 6 (10 marks) [10 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question also assesses reading with understanding through a Cloze Text and candidates have to fill in the blanks with the given words.

Comments:

- ❖ The majority of candidates attempted this question but only a few managed to score full marks.
- ❖ Candidates frequently lost marks due to hasty comprehension and misunderstanding of the content or given words.
- ❖ Several candidates confused between طيبا and مريضا due to resemblance in their ending cases and vowels.
- ❖ A few candidates left the section entirely blank, suggesting a lack of confidence or time.

Recommendations:

Educators should merge pedagogical strategies with practical student-facing techniques to improve performance in Arabic Cloze tests. Educators are recommended to:

- Encourage students to engage with Arabic short stories, news snippets, and age-appropriate books.
- Train students to view the passage as a cohesive narrative. Practice identifying transition words that connect the logic of one sentence to the next.
- Guide students to read the entire passage from start to finish to grasp the overarching theme. A clear understanding of the subject matter makes selecting the appropriate word much more intuitive.
- Teach students to analyze a blank's requirements before looking at the word bank. Is the missing word a noun, a verb, or a particle.
- Encourage students to strike out words that are grammatically impossible (e.g., a masculine word for a feminine noun) or contextually "off." This narrows the field and reduces anxiety.
- Direct students to read the completed passage once all the blanks are filled to ensure it "sounds" right. If the grammar or logic feels inappropriate, it's a red flag to re-evaluate their choices.

Question 7A (5 marks) [5 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses candidates' knowledge of grammar and spelling in context. Sentences containing grammatical and spelling mistakes are set and candidates have to correct these mistakes.

Comments:

- ❖ The vast majority of candidates attempted this question but only a few managed to score full marks.
- ❖ A few candidates merely copied the underlined words rather than applying the required modifications.
- ❖ A significant number of candidates were not able to answer item number 4 correctly.
- ❖ The question assessed the following:
 - Item 1: Demonstrative Pronouns; agreement between the distal demonstrative pronoun (ذَلِكَ) and the masculine noun (فَرَسٌ) was required instead of the feminine form (تِلْكَ). The masculine gender of the noun is further confirmed by the accompanying adjective (أَسْوَدٌ).
 - Item 2: Attached Object Pronouns; the 3rd person feminine singular suffix (هَا) was required to correctly refer back to the feminine noun (الْعَبَّيَّة) instead of the masculine suffix (هُ). Candidates often struggle with pronoun-antecedent agreement when the object is a feminine inanimate noun.
 - Item 3: Verb Conjugation; in a nominal sentence starting with a plural subject (الْمُعَلِّمُونَ), the 3rd person masculine plural verb form (يَشْرَحُونَ) was required instead of the singular form (يَشْرَحُ). This tested the candidate's ability to maintain number agreement between the subject and the predicate verb.
 - Item 4: Spelling (Orthography); the verb (تَحْفَظُ) was required to be spelled with the letter (ظ) instead of the letter (ض) in (تَحْفَضُ). This item targeted common phonological confusion between similar-sounding emphatic letters.
 - Item 5: The Genitive Case (Al-Jarr); the noun following the preposition (فِي) was required to be in the genitive case ending with a *kasra* (الْحَقِيبَةُ) instead of the nominative case ending with a *damma* (الْحَقِيبَةُ).

The following is a list of the correct and wrong answers:

Item	Correct Sentences	Wrong answers
1	ذلك / هذا	هذه
2	ها	ي
3	يشرحون / شرحوا	تشرح
4	تحفظ / تحفل	تحفد
5	الحقيية / ة	الحقية

Recommendations:

To help students bridge the gap between "knowing" and "applying" rules, educators are recommended to:

- Ensure students understand that the objective is to rectify the specific error within the provided word, rather than substituting it with an entirely different synonym or alternative phrase.
- Incorporate frequent dictation drills specifically designed to isolate and eliminate recurring orthographic (spelling) trends.
- Pupils are encouraged to maintain a "difficulty log"—a dedicated list of words they find challenging—to facilitate consistent, focused practice.
- Move beyond isolated corrections by identifying and discussing recurring error trends within the class.
- Give students the chance to hunt down and fix their own slips before correcting the mistakes.
- Encourage students to exchange work. Identifying errors in a peer's writing often helps them become more vigilant in their own.
- Use clarifying questions to prompt students to think critically about their syntax.

- Avoid overwhelming the learner; focus on mastering one category of error (e.g., gender agreement) before moving to the next.
- Evaluate the writing as a whole and prioritize corrections based on what most affects the clarity and meaning of the message.

Question 7B (5 marks) [5 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses knowledge and application of word transformation rules in Arabic. Sentences are set and candidates have to complete the gaps by carrying out the correct transformation of the given words.

Comments:

- ❖ While the majority of candidates engaged with this question, achieving full marks proved challenging for many due to underlying grammatical or orthographic inaccuracies in their responses.
- ❖ A number of candidates were unable to secure full credit because, despite identifying the correct word form, they applied incorrect diacritical markings.
- ❖ Certain candidates failed to apply the necessary linguistic transformations, instead merely transcribing the words exactly as they appeared in the prompt.

The following is a list of the correct and wrong answers:

Item	Correct Sentences	Partly correct answers	Wrong answers
1	لاعب / لاعبان / لاعبون	لاعبين / لاعبة / لاعبتان / لاعبات	ملعب / ألعاب
2	أنظف	انظف	نظيفة
3	عاملون / عمال	العاملون	عاملان / عاملات
4	مكتب / مكتبة		كتب
5	انتظار	نظر	ناظر

Recommendations:

- Observations indicate that while candidates often possess the correct conceptual answers, they frequently fail to execute the proper orthography. Consequently, educators are encouraged to prioritize dictation exercises from an early stage to build foundational spelling accuracy.
- When introducing new vocabulary, educators should present students with various morphological derivatives. To reinforce this, candidates should be regularly tasked with incorporating these different word forms into original sentence-writing exercises.
- Interactive classroom activities should be implemented where students are challenged to derive the maximum number of words possible from a single root, fostering a deeper understanding of linguistic patterns and word formation.
- Students should practice stripping a word down to its three-letter root to understand how prefixes and suffixes change its meaning and grammatical role.
- Educators need to encourage students to memorize common weight patterns (Awzan). For instance, knowing the difference between the 3rd person singular and the 3rd person feminine plural becomes much easier when the pattern is internalized.

Question 8 (10 marks) [5 Items]

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses candidates' ability to use simple cohesive devices (like adverbs of time, manner or place) or conjunctions to write sentences. The task is based on pictures and given words. The different sentences must be linked together with the given words to make up a coherent short story.

Comments:

- ❖ While the vast majority of candidates attempted this 10-mark question, very few succeeded in attaining full marks due to specific execution failures regarding the rubric.
- ❖ Candidates generally understood the story's visual context, correctly identifying the sequence of events shown in the five pictures (playing, falling, crying, being helped, returning home).
- ❖ The instructions explicitly require writing one complete sentence for *each picture*, incorporating *both* given words. Numerous marks were lost when candidates either:
 - Omitted one of the two given words (e.g., using only لَعِبَ but forgetting ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ).

- Wrote two separate, short phrases instead of blending the words into a single, cohesive sentence.
- ❖ Despite the clear, five-stage progression in the images (from playing to return), many candidates failed to link the five sentences logically. They presented a collection of isolated facts rather than crafting a short, fluent, and unified story.
- ❖ While some sentences were grammatically sound, they were marked down because they did not align with the specific visual evidence. For example, some failed to use the time markers correctly (e.g., placing 'فَجأةً' (Suddenly) in a context that was not sudden, like the final picture).
- ❖ Several candidates even managed to copy the given, vocalized words with orthographic mistakes.
- ❖ The following is a list of some good and poor stories:

	Criteria	Correct and meaningful Sentences	Item
☐ Given words used ☐ Meaningful ☐ Coherent to image ☐ Appropriate Vocabulary ☐ Correct syntax ☐ No grammatical / spelling mistake	<u>EXCELLENT</u>	ذات يوم كان يوسف يلعب كرة القدم	1
		فجأة سقط على الأرض وجرح	2
		ثم بكى لأنه كان يشعر بالألم	3
		بعد قليل جاء صديق ه أحمد وساعده	4
		أخيرا أخذه أحمد إلى البيت	5
	Criteria	Meaningful Sentences with mistakes	Item
☐ Given words used ☐ Meaningful ☐ Incoherent to image ☐ Correct syntax ☐ Grammatical / spelling mistake	<u>AVERAGE</u>	ذات يوم يلعب يوسف كرة القدم	1
		فجأة سقط على أرض	2
		ثم بكى لأنه كان يشعر بالألم	3
		بعد قليل جاء صديق أحمد	4
		أخيرا رجع إلى البيت	5

	Criteria	Incorrect Sentences	Item
☐ Not meaningful ☐ Incoherent to image ☐ Incorrect syntax ☐ Grammatical / spelling mistakes ☐ Simply copying given words	<u>POOR</u>	ذات يوم يلعب يوسف الكرة القدم	1
		فجأة سقط صديقي إلى أرض	2
		ثم بكى يوسف	3
		بعد قليل إلى صديق	4
		أخيرا إلى البيت	5

Recommendations:

- ❖ Educators are strongly advised to encourage students to practice crafting concise, cohesive paragraphs.
- ❖ Candidates must be explicitly reminded of the following structural and grammatical principles:
 - **Word Order:** The provided vocabulary may be utilized in any logical sequence.
 - **Verb Conjugation:** Verbs may be adapted into any grammatically appropriate tense to suit the narrative context.
 - **Mandatory Inclusion:** All provided words must be explicitly incorporated into the answer.
 - **Single Sentence Rule:** Only one complete sentence must be written per picture, and the given words must be integrated within that same sentence.
 - **Avoid Superficial Links:** Candidates must abstain from merely inserting a preposition between the two target words without building a proper clause.
 - **Proper Nouns:** Repurposing the provided common vocabulary as proper nouns (e.g., using them as character names) is strictly unacceptable.
 - **Syntactical Precision:** The unjustified addition or omission of critical structural elements, such as prepositions, constitutes a syntactical error and will be penalized.
 - **Diacritical Marks:** Candidates should avoid writing diacritical marks to minimize the risk of unforced errors.
 - **Originality:** Stereotyped sentences must be avoided.

Question 9 (10 marks)

Assessment Objective:

This question assesses candidates' ability to write creatively and imaginatively a coherent and structured piece of continuous prose by using correct grammar, spelling and punctuation accurately and by using vocabularies appropriate to the situation and topic. This is done through a guided composition (canvas).

Comments:

- ❖ This composition task required candidates to write approximately 100 words detailing a personal narrative based on five specific prompts.
- ❖ While the vast majority of candidates attempted this question, only a select few fully addressed the rubric criteria to secure maximum marks.
- ❖ A recurring issue was the use of unnecessarily lengthy introductions that delayed the main narrative. Furthermore, several candidates submitted rehearsed, generic essays that lacked relevance to the specific scenario of getting lost in a market, resulting in a significant loss of marks.
- ❖ Instead of using the bullet points as a structural guide, many candidates simply transcribed the prompts verbatim, occasionally bridging them with basic conjunctions or prepositions.
- ❖ A common structural flaw was dedicating the entire word count to expanding on the first two points (going to the market and the crowds), leaving the climax of the story (getting lost and seeking help) undeveloped or entirely omitted.
- ❖ Only a top tier of candidates successfully employed a diverse range of sentence structures to create a fluid, engaging storyline.
- ❖ Since this is a recount of a past event, the narrative required the past tense. Many weaker candidates struggled with tense coherence, inappropriately mixing imperfect (present) and perfect (past) verbs throughout the story.
- ❖ Examiners noted frequent breakdowns in foundational grammar, including subject-verb agreement, accurate verb conjugation, proper gender forms, and the correct application of auxiliary verbs.
- ❖ Despite the topic being highly accessible, many candidates lacked the lexical resource to describe the market environment or the emotional response to getting lost, leading to the misuse of prepositions and phrasal verbs.

- ❖ Examiners highlighted the following recurring mistakes in candidate scripts:
 - **Tanween Orthography:** Omission of the final *Alif* when applying *Tanween Fatha* (e.g., writing شديد instead of شديد).
 - **Hamza Placement:** Consistent failure to write the *Hamza* on the *Alif* for the short vowel sounds *a, i, u* (أ / إ / /).
 - **Auxiliary Verb Conjugation:** Inability to conjugate the verb كَانَ (to be) with attached pronouns. Candidates erroneously wrote disjointed phrases like (كان أنا) instead of the correct form (كُنْتُ).
 - **Phonological Confusion:** Swapping similar-sounding letters such as (ق / خ) and (س / ص). For example, writing متأخرًا instead of متأخرًا (late).
 - **Pronoun Attachment:** Failing to attach pronouns directly to prepositions, writing (إلى أنا) instead of the grammatically correct (إليَّ).
 - **Particle Confusion (أَنَّ vs. أَنْ):** Misunderstanding the syntactic rules governing these particles, frequently placing a verb directly after أَنْ or a noun after أَنَّ.
 - **The Genitive Construction (الإضافة):** A very high frequency of errors regarding definiteness in *Idafa* structures. Candidates incorrectly added the definite article (ال) to the first part of the construction (*Mudaf*) ز.
 - **Adjective-Noun Agreement:** Failing to match adjectives with their nouns in gender and definiteness (e.g., مكان مختلف instead of مكان مختلفة).

To provide a clear distinction between performance levels for the "Visit to the Market" narrative, here are three sample compositions. These illustrate the strengths and weaknesses discussed in the report.

Sample 1: Excellent (Score: 9–10)

ذات يوم، قررت الذهاب إلى السوق المركزي لوحي لأشتري بعض الفواكه الطازجة. عندما وصلت إلى هناك، رأيت ناساً كثيرين يزدحمون في كل مكان، وكانت الأصوات تتعالى من كل جانب. بينما كنت أمشي وسط هذه الزحمة الكبيرة، فقدت طريقي فجأة ولم أعرف كيف أعود إلى مكان السيارة. في تلك اللحظة، شعرت بالقلق والخوف يسيطران عليّ، لذلك بحثت عن مساعدة حتى وجدت شرطياً يقف عند الزاوية. لحسن الحظ، كان الرجل طيباً جداً، حيث ساعدني بكل سرور وأرشدني إلى الطريق الصحيح. أخيراً، عدت إلى منزلي بسلام وأنا أشعر بالراحة بعد هذه التجربة المثيرة التي لن أنساها أبداً.

Analysis: This script uses a variety of sentence structures and correct transitions (بَيِّنَمَا، لِذَلِكَ، لِحُسْنِ (الْحَظِّ)). It addresses all five prompts, maintains past tense consistency, and shows accurate adjective-noun agreement.

Sample 2: Average (Score: 5–7)

في يوم التالي، أنا ذهب إلى سوق كبير لوحدي لكي أشتري بعض الأشياء. كان هناك ناس كثيرون في كل مكان، والسوق كان زحمة جداً وصاخب. فجأة، أنا فقدت طريقي في وسط تلك الشوارع الكبيرة ولم أجد مكان للخروج. أنا كان خائف جداً وشعرت بالضيق، لذلك ذهبت إلى رجل طيب وطلبت المساعدة منه لكي أجد الطريق. بعد ذلك، أنا اتصلت بوالدي الذي جاء بسرعة، ثم أنا رجعت إلى البيت معه وأنا سعيد. حقاً كان يوم جميل ومثير.

Analysis: While the story is coherent and follows the prompts, it suffers from "linguistic poverty." The candidate repeats the pronoun "أنا" excessively and makes several agreement errors (e.g., سَوق instead of كَبيرَة). There are also mistakes in pronoun perspective (لِوَحْدِكَ instead of لِوَحْدِي).

Sample 3: Poor (Score: 1–3)

زيارة السوق لوحدي. ناس كثيرون في السوق. أنا يمشي في طريق طويل. فجأة فقدت طريقك ولا أعرف أين البيت. طلبت المساعدة من رجل لكن هو لا يعرف. أنا كان خائف جداً ويبكي كثيراً. بعد قليل، السائق الحافلة جاء وقال أنا يساعد أنت. هو رجل جيد. أخيراً في يمشي إلى البيت مع السائق. أنا سعيد الآن.

Analysis: This response is a classic example of "prompt copying." The candidate has essentially listed the bullet points with minimal modification. It contains major grammatical breakdowns (e.g., كَانْ أَنَا and السَّائِقُ الحَافِلَة), lacks narrative flow, and fails to reach the required word count.

Recommendations:

- Candidates must be taught that a top-tier composition is a synthesis of topical relevance and linguistic flow. Encourage them to move beyond "listing events" and instead focus on detailed, elaborately developed narratives that showcase complex sentence structures and a sophisticated lexical resource.
- It is imperative to reinforce that narrative writing primarily requires the **Perfect Tense (الفعل الماضي)**. Educators should emphasize that maintaining a consistent timeline is crucial for narrative clarity and scoring.
- Encourage the use of varied grammatical applications. Students should be moving beyond simple Subject-Verb-Object structures to incorporate relative clauses, varied connectors, and descriptive adjectives.
- Educators are encouraged to facilitate classroom discussions where students can share ideas. During these sessions, provide students with dedicated "thematic toolkits" containing relevant vocabulary, logical connectors (\$روابط\$), and idiomatic expressions.
- Teachers are advised to explicitly highlight the different rhetorical styles and modes of expression unique to the Arabic language, moving students away from direct translations of their native tongues.
- Educators are encouraged to cultivate a culture of thoughtful and precise writing. While creativity is encouraged, educators should apply rigorous feedback to discourage "rote-learned" or meaningless sentences that do not serve the story.
- Candidates must understand that extensive reading is the foundation of effective language production. Regular exposure to high-quality Arabic texts allows them to internalize patterns that they can later replicate in their own writing.
- Rather than assigning full-length essays once a month, organize brief, frequent writing drills on specific subjects. This builds "linguistic stamina" and helps students learn to express their thoughts under time constraints.
- Educators should work on the candidates' mindset by employing motivational techniques. Use positive reinforcement to inspire confidence and curiosity, ensuring that the rigors of the Arabic language challenge them without becoming a source of performance anxiety.

Conclusion

In summary, it is essential that pupils prioritize the practice of reading with comprehension. The primary cause of many challenges faced by candidates appears to be a failure to grasp the nuanced meanings within the texts they read. Consequently, sustained efforts must be directed toward the continuous development of their writing skills.

To achieve this, pupils are encouraged to read extensively, looking beyond the scope of standard Arabic textbooks. It is important to remember that textbooks serve only as a foundational tool for implementing the Teaching and Learning Syllabus, which is aligned with the National Curriculum Framework (NCF). Their principal function is to supplement and enrich the direct input and pedagogical instructions provided by educators.

Educators are, therefore, requested to give careful consideration to the specific recommendations detailed throughout the various sections of this report. It is crucial that appropriate instructional strategies and practical means are devised to apply these recommendations effectively within the classroom environment.